Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Title

Deploying the Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application in Zoho Creator from the Development environment to the Stage and Production environments.

Aim

To understand the multi-stage deployment process of Zoho Creator, and to move the Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application from Development to Stage for testing and then to Production for real use.

Objectives

- To understand the three environments: Development, Stage and Production.
- To open the Environments page and read the status of the application in each stage.
- To learn how a version is published to Stage, tested, and then published to Production.
- To read the email notifications that Zoho Creator sends for each deployment step.
- To understand why testing in Stage protects the live application.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (Environments feature under Deploy)
- Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application
- Web browser with internet connection
- Email account to receive deployment notifications

Introduction / Theory

Application deployment: Deployment means moving an application from the place where it is built to the place where users work with it. If changes are made directly on a live application, a small mistake can stop real users. So Zoho Creator gives separate environments.

Environments in Zoho Creator: The Environments feature is a multi-stage space to test and publish an application without affecting production. It has three parts.

Environment	Purpose
Development	The place where developers build and change the application: forms, reports, workflows and settings.
Stage	A copy used for testing. Changes are checked here with sample data before real users see them.
Production	The live application used by the real users. Only tested versions should reach this stage.

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Versions: Every time a change is published, Zoho Creator saves it as a version, such as 1.0. A version can be Major (new features and updates) or Minor (small changes and bug fixes). The Version History option helps us see earlier versions.

Maintenance mode: While a version is being published, the application can be set to maintenance mode and will not be available until the publish is complete. So publishing is best done when few users are active.

Deployment Flow

The flow of a change from build to live use is shown below.

Stage	Environment	What happens
1	Development	Build or change the application.
2	Stage	Publish the version to Stage and test it.
3	Production	Publish the tested version for real users.
4	Production	Check that the live application works well.

Procedure

Step 1: Open the Environments page

1. Log in to Zoho Creator with the Zoho account.
2. In the left menu, under Deploy, click Environments.
3. The page shows the application name and two columns, Stage and Production.

Step 2: Check the application status

4. Find Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management in the list. Under its name, the page shows the message No changes available, which means there are no pending changes to publish.
5. Read the version in each column. Stage and Production both show version 1.0.

Step 3: Read the creation email

6. When the application was added to Environments, Zoho Creator sent an email to confirm it.
7. The email says the application was created in both the Development and Stage environments and is ready for further development.

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Output

1. Environments Page

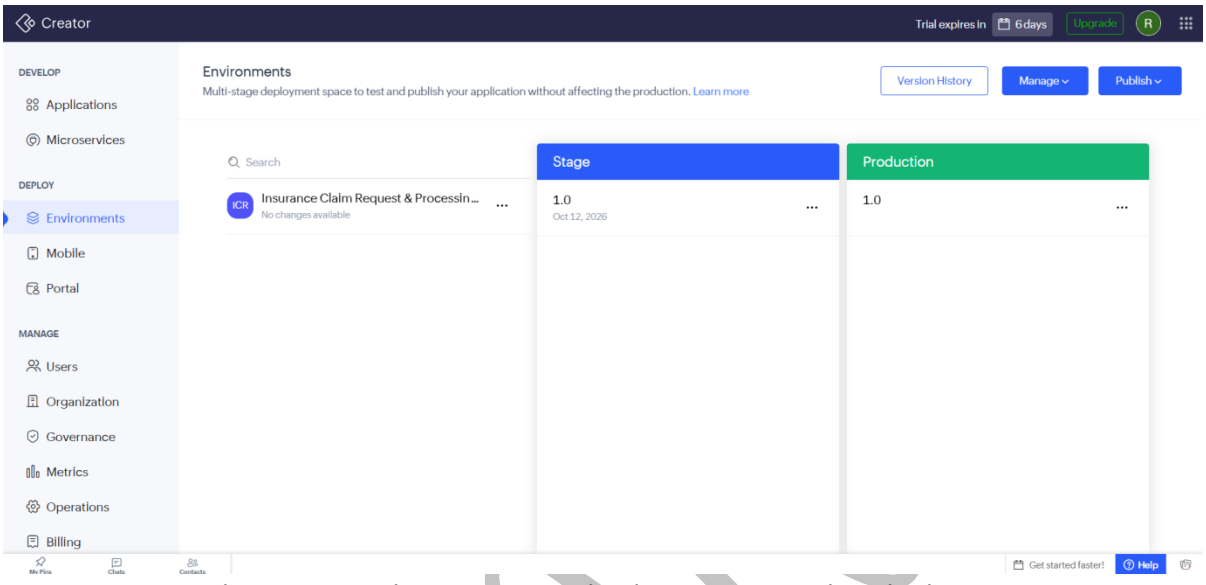


Figure 11.1: Environments page showing Stage 1.0 and Production 1.0

2. Environment Creation Email

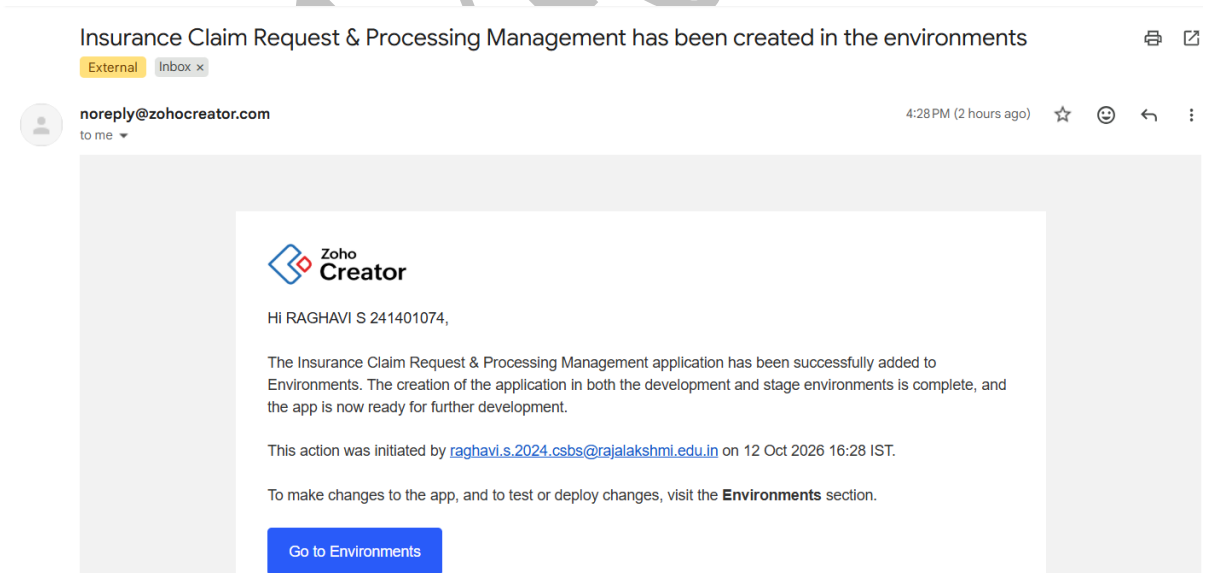


Figure 11.2: Email confirming the application was added to Environments

Procedure to Publish a New Version

When changes are made in Development, a new version is deployed with these steps.

Step 4: Publish to Stage

8. On the Environments page, click Publish and choose Publish to Stage.
9. Select the application and review the changes that will be deployed.
10. Enter a title and a description for the version, choose Major or Minor, and add an email for notification.
11. Click Publish and wait. Zoho Creator sends an email when the publish is complete.

Step 5: Test in Stage

12. Open the application in Stage.
13. Submit a few sample claims and check that the Claim_Request_Form saves them.
14. Open the report and the dashboard and check that the records and charts are correct.

Step 6: Publish to Production

15. Click Publish and choose Production.
16. Select the version that was tested in Stage and review the details.
17. Click Publish and wait for the success email.

Step 7: Verify Production

18. Open the application in Production and check that it opens without problems.
19. Check the form, the report and the dashboard once more.

Note: In this experiment, the screenshots show the Environments page and the creation email. A new version publish was not captured, so Steps 4 to 7 describe the standard process.

Observation

- The Environments page describes itself as a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without affecting production.
- The Insurance Claim application appears in the list with the message No changes available, so there is nothing waiting to be published.
- Stage shows version 1.0 with the date Oct 12, 2026, and Production also shows version 1.0.
- The Version History, Manage and Publish buttons are at the top right of the page.
- The email was sent on 12 Oct 2026 at 16:28 IST. It confirms that the app was created in the Development and Stage environments.
- The account is a trial account that expires in 6 days, so some features may be limited.

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Best Practices for Deployment

Practice	Reason
Always test in Stage first	Errors are found before real users are affected.
Write a clear version title and description	It is easy to know what changed in each version.
Use Minor for small fixes and Major for big updates	Version numbers tell the size of the change.
Publish when few users are active	The application may go into maintenance mode.
Keep the notification email on	The team knows when a deployment is complete.

Limitations

The screenshots show the application already present in Stage and Production at version 1.0. A new Publish to Stage or Publish to Production action was not captured, so those steps are explained as the standard procedure and are not claimed as done in this report.

Conclusion

The multi-stage Environments feature of Zoho Creator keeps the live application safe. Changes are built in Development, tested in Stage and then published to Production as a tested version. Version numbers, notification emails and the Version History make every deployment easy to track. The Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application is available in the Stage and Production environments at version 1.0.

Final Result

- The Environments page was opened and the application status was checked.
- The Stage and Production environments were seen with version 1.0 for the Insurance Claim application.
- The deployment email was read, and the process of publishing a version from Development to Stage and Production was understood.

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